

Early childhood education: How are demographics associated with total seats and occupied seats?

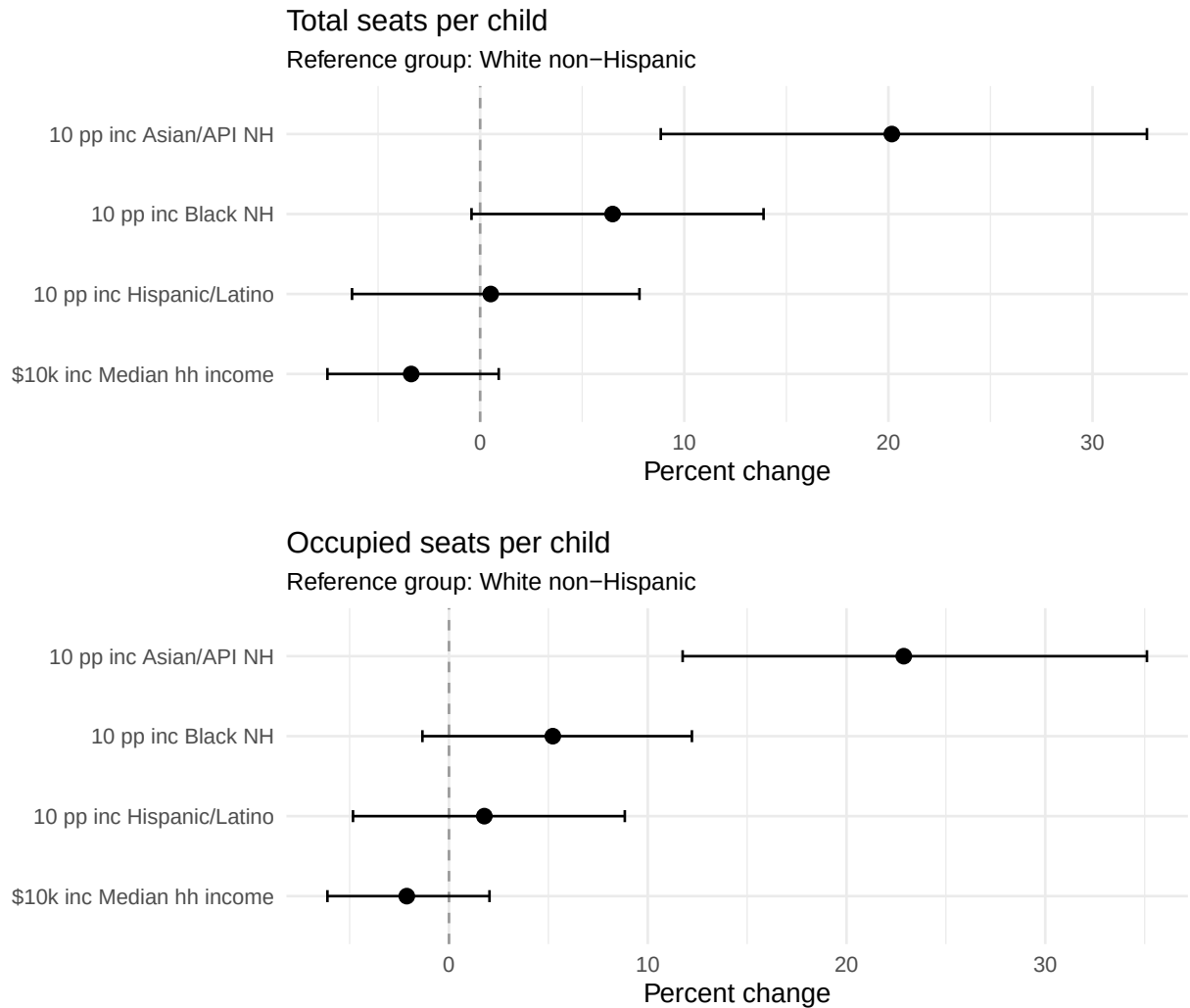
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We explored neighborhood variation in DOE early childhood education (ECE) seats per preschool-age child (ages 3–4) and occupied ECE seats per preschool-age child. We estimated the relationship between the number of seats and number of occupied seats per child and neighborhood race/ethnicity shares, median household income.

The two models tell a consistent story. Asian/API non-Hispanic population share has the strongest association with early childhood education (ECE) access. **A 10 percentage-point increase in the Asian/API non-Hispanic population share is associated with approximately 20% more licensed seats per preschool-age child and 23% more occupied seats per preschool-age child.** This suggests a relationship between participation in ECE programs and number of seats per child in an area.

Black non-Hispanic population share is also positively associated with ECE capacity, but the association is attenuated after adjusting for median household income. Median household income has a slight negative association with seats, though the estimate is not significant. Hispanic/Latino population share is not associated with seats after adjustment.

Coefficient Plots



Occupied Seats Map

Occupied ECE seats per preschool-age child

